

OCBC Bank

GE beats on investment income; upside to OCBC 3Q results

Great Eastern (GE SP, not covered) reported 3Q25 net income of S\$372mn, up 50% q/q and 36% y/y. OCBC's share of earnings accounts for 20% of our 3Q25E earnings vs. 15% average in last 2 quarters. This suggests ~5% upside risk to OCBC 3Q25 earnings, to be released next Friday (Nov. 7). The bottom-line strength was driven by robust mark-to-market and investment gains, which supported both the insurance business and shareholders' funds. Core business was steady, with TWNS up 3% q/q and down 5% y/y, as q/q growth in Singapore offset weak performance in Malaysia. NBEV trended stronger (+9% q/q), due to a shift in product mix towards longer-term. This set of results suggests likely strength in non-II in OCBC's 3Q results, which could potentially offset NIM weakness. Yet, the nature of the beat makes it difficult to extrapolate going forward.

Treasury income has been firm at global banks, and we believe all three Singapore banks will benefit from broader capital markets-related income ([link](#) to our preview). Last night's hawkish cut from the Fed ([link](#), [link](#)) potentially lowers the pressure on SORA for now, and may be a net positive for rates/NIM outlook for next 3-6M for the sector. We hold OW on DBS and UW on UOB into numbers, with N on OCBC.

Neutral

OCBC.SI, OCBC SP

Price (29 Oct 25): S\$16.85

Price Target (Dec-26): S\$17.00

APAC Banks

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Table 1: GE: 3Q25 Earnings Snapshot

\$mm	3Q25	2Q25	1Q25	4Q24	3Q24	2Q24	1Q24	QoQ	YoY
Total Weighted New Sales	373.1	363.5	345.1	432.7	390.8	448.3	524.2	3%	-5%
New Business Embedded Value	182.2	167.7	148.8	105.7	156.1	146.5	125.5	9%	17%
Profit from Insurance Business	228.8	168.4	246.8	92.6	186.4	215.4	236.3	36%	23%
Profit from Shareholders' Fund	143.2	79.8	98.7	42.2	87.0	65.0	70.4	79%	65%
Profit Attributable to Shareholders	372.0	248.2	345.5	134.8	273.4	280.4	306.7	50%	36%

Source: Company data.

Table 2: GE: New Business Embedded Value (NBEV) by market

\$ millions	3Q25	2Q25	1Q25	4Q24	3Q24	2Q24	1Q24	QoQ	YoY
Singapore	102	67	71	75	62	58	49	53%	66%
Malaysia	77	99	75	115	92	87	75	-22%	-16%
Emerging Markets	3	2	2	3	3	2	2	22%	12%
Total	182	168	149	193	156	147	126	9%	17%

Source: Company data.

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Table 3: GE: Total Weighted New Sales (TWNS) by market

\$ millions	3Q25	2Q25	1Q25	4Q24	3Q24	2Q24	1Q24	QoQ	YoY
SINGAPORE									
Agency	117	92	102	135	156	200	277	27%	-25%
Banca	124	119	94	84	83	90	119	4%	50%
Others	11	19	20	10	13	18	18	-42%	-15%
<i>Total Weighted New Sales</i>	252	230	216	229	251	308	414	10%	0%
MALAYSIA									
Agency	102	113	90	179	116	103	87	-9%	-12%
Banca	6	5	6	9	7	7	6	8%	-21%
Others	6	9	26	6	6	24	8	-40%	-7%
<i>Total Weighted New Sales</i>	113	127	122	194	129	134	102	-11%	-12%
OTHER ASIA									
<i>Total Weighted New Sales</i>	8	7	8	10	10	7	9	22%	-21%
TOTAL									
Total Weighted New Sales	373	364	345	433	391	448	524	3%	-5%

Source: Company data.

Table 4: OCBC: 3Q25 Earnings Preview

P&L (\$\$mn)	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25E	YoY	QoQ
Interest Income	5,596	5,617	5,411	4,993	4,834	-14%	-3%
Interest Expense	(3,163)	(3,162)	(3,066)	(2,710)	(2,611)	-17%	-4%
Net Interest Income	2,433	2,455	2,345	2,283	2,222	-9%	-3%
Non-Interest Income	1,369	961	1,310	1,264	1,271	-7%	1%
Net Fee Income	508	517	546	580	568	12%	-2%
Trading Income	628	343	458	458	442	-30%	-3%
Other Operating Income	233	101	306	226	260	12%	15%
Total Revenues	3,802	3,416	3,655	3,547	3,493	-8%	-2%
Costs	(1,463)	(1,560)	(1,415)	(1,389)	(1,419)	-3%	2%
PPOP	2,339	1,856	2,240	2,158	2,074	-11%	-4%
Loan Loss Provisions	(169)	(297)	(212)	(87)	(213)	26%	145%
Pre-Tax	2,414	1,888	2,297	2,301	2,131	-12%	-7%
Tax	(339)	(235)	(390)	(439)	(320)	-6%	-27%
Profit before MI	2,075	1,653	1,907	1,862	1,811	-13%	-3%
MI and EO	(101)	34	(24)	(46)	(46)	-54%	0%
Core Attributable Profit	1,974	1,687	1,883	1,816	1,765	-11%	-3%
Reported Net Profits	1,974	1,687	1,883	1,816	1,765	-11%	-3%
DPS (\$\$)	-	0.57	-	0.41	-	n.a	-100%
Common Equity	55,932	57,616	59,866	58,749	58,396	4%	-1%
Gross Loans	305,417	319,166	322,175	324,606	328,439	8%	1%
Net Loans	301,285	315,096	317,885	320,413	324,090	8%	1%
Deposits	369,280	390,687	402,732	406,943	410,103	11%	1%
NPLs	2,745	2,827	2,898	2,983	3,088	13%	4%
LLR	4,132	4,070	4,290	4,193	4,350	5%	4%
Change in bps							
NIM	2.18%	2.15%	2.04%	1.92%	1.83%	(35)	(9)
CIR	38.5%	45.7%	38.7%	39.2%	40.6%	215	147
LDR	82%	81%	79%	79%	79%	(256)	29
CASA Ratio	48.4%	48.8%	48.9%	49.8%	49.8%	138	(1)
Credit Costs (bps)	22	38	26	11	26	4	15
NPL Ratio	0.90%	0.89%	0.90%	0.92%	0.94%	4	2
Coverage Ratio	151%	144%	148%	141%	141%	(969)	27
Tier 1	17.9%	17.8%	18.3%	17.8%	17.1%	(78)	(63)
CAR	19.8%	19.7%	20.2%	19.6%	18.9%	(89)	(69)

Source: Company reports, J.P. Morgan estimates.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

OCBC Bank *(Neutral; Price Target: S\$17.00)*

Investment Thesis

We hold a Neutral rating on OCBC.

- The bank is witnessing a sharper decline in NIM vs. peers, off a higher base as SGD rates continue to come off. Guidance suggests further risks. We expect 29bps/17bps NIM compression in FY25/26E, following a sharp 28bps decline over the last 4 quarters.
- We forecast 11.5-12.2% RoE over 2025-27, with WM being a bright spot. The bank is benefitting from significant inflows of funds into Singapore, and in SGD. The preference for NII growth suggests that the risks to NIM may be higher as rates reset lower.
- We forecast 50% regular payout ratio in 2025-27, with 11-15% payout in form of special dividends. Basically, we assume that the absolute DPS will stay steady in 2025-27, despite EPS movements. In case the bank allows DPS to reduce in line with EPS, it'll be a risk. We further forecast S\$700-750mn of buyback every year, which adds about 1% to total returns.
- The bank has expanded inorganically over the last 10-15 years, with Wing Hang and Bank of Ningbo being notable transactions. There appears to be a commitment to deepen this presence, with capabilities being broadened in the GBA and HK markets, among others. This could lead to near-term risks if the growth in Greater China is via inorganic means and transactions are not immediately accretive.

Valuation

Our Dec-26 PT of S\$17 is based on a fair P/B of 1.16x, assuming a normalized RoE of 12.0%, a risk-free rate of 4.7%, a cost of capital of 10.4% and a growth rate of 1.0%.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Upside risks include a significant improvement in DPS, a meaningfully value-accretive deal, better than-expected growth at GE, and better-than-expected WM fees. Bank of Ningbo (20%-owned by OCBC) has competitive advantages in local SMEs and high-net-worth retail clients, which can drive faster growth at the group.

Downside risks include weaker than expected NIM, market share losses in wealth management, and M&A, if transactions are not immediately accretive.

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OCBC Bank (OCBC.SI, OCBC SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$\$)	Price Target (\$\$)
01-Nov-22	N	12.13	13
06-Jan-23	OW	12.44	14
09-Mar-23	OW	12.55	13.5
30-Mar-23	UW	12.53	11.5
13-Mar-24	UW	13.09	12.5
10-May-24	NR	13.91	--
13-Jul-25	N	16.89	18
08-Aug-25	N	17.09	17.5
10-Sep-25	N	16.76	17

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Feb 24, 2000. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

DBS Group Holdings (DBSM.SI, DBS SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$\$)	Price Target (\$\$)
23-Nov-22	N	32.34	34
09-Mar-23	N	30.64	31
30-Mar-23	UW	30.54	27
05-Oct-23	UW	30.20	28
09-Dec-23	UW	28.73	27.5
13-Mar-24	N	30.46	30
03-Jul-24	OW	37.10	41
06-Oct-24	OW	38.04	42
10-Nov-24	OW	42.40	50
11-Feb-25	OW	45.38	51
23-Mar-25	OW	45.31	49
21-May-25	N	44.38	47
13-Jul-25	N	45.99	48
08-Aug-25	N	49.75	50.5
10-Sep-25	OW	50.88	56

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Dec 11, 2001. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

United Overseas Bank (UOB) (UOBH.SI, UOB SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$\$)	Price Target (\$\$)
30-Mar-23	N	29.95	28.5
05-Oct-23	N	28.07	28
09-Dec-23	N	27.58	27
13-Mar-24	N	28.28	30
03-Jul-24	N	31.65	32.5
06-Oct-24	N	31.86	34
10-Nov-24	OW	35.69	41
14-Jan-25	OW	36.80	43
23-Mar-25	N	37.95	40
21-May-25	N	35.40	37
13-Jul-25	N	36.86	38
08-Aug-25	N	35.81	36.5
10-Sep-25	UW	35.57	32.5

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
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